Speak to Travel — Complete Teaching Materials

> English conversation programs for Portuguese speakers
> Teacher: Diogo Barbosa

What's inside

1. **3-Month Program (Teacher's Book):** 12 weeks, 36 sessions, for students who know a little English
2. **Express 1-Month Program:** 4 weeks, 12 sessions, for students who know English but can't hold a conversation
3. **Error Guide:** the mistakes Brazilians make (pronunciation, false friends, translated sentences)
4. **Question Bank:** role-play and interview questions (immigration, visa, hotel, restaurant, doctor, small talk, job)
5. **Student Sheets:** diagnostic form, "My Story" card, weekly self-check, emergency card, certificate

Speak to Travel — 12-Week Intensive English Conversation Program

> **Teacher's book** for private, 1-on-1 (or pairs) conversation classes. **Students:** adult Portuguese speakers (40+ usually) who studied *some* English, understand a little, but **freeze when they have to speak** — especially before a trip or an interview. **Duration:** 12 weeks maximum · 3 sessions per week · 60 minutes = **36 sessions** (≈36 hours of speaking + homework). **Only conversation.** Grammar appears only when it unlocks a sentence the student needs to *say*.

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Companion files:

- **File 3 (Error Guide)** — the mistakes Portuguese speakers make (pronunciation, false friends, "translated" sentences) and how to fix each one
- **File 4 (Question Bank)** — interview & role-play question bank (airport immigration, consulate, hotel, doctor, emergencies)
- **File 5 (Student Sheets)** — printable student sheets: diagnostic, "My Story" card, weekly self-check, final certificate checklist

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1. The promise (and the honest limit)

What you promise the student:

> "In 12 weeks you will be able to travel alone, pass immigration, check in, order food, ask for help, handle a problem, talk about yourself for 2 minutes, and survive a 10-minute conversation with a stranger — without panic."

What you do NOT promise: fluency. Nobody becomes fluent in 36 hours. Tell the student this on day one — older adults respect honesty, and it lowers anxiety. The real target is roughly **CEFR A2 → B1 in speaking** (CEFR = the European scale A1 → C2 that schools use; A2 = "basic survival", B1 = "can handle most travel situations").

The real problem these students have is not vocabulary. It is:

1. **Fear / blocking** ("trava") — they know the words but can't get them out.
2. **Translating from Portuguese in their head**, sentence by sentence.
3. **Listening speed** — real people talk fast and connect words.
4. **Pronunciation habits** that make them hard to understand (and make them feel embarrassed).

Everything in this program attacks those four things.

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2. The method — 7 principles

#	Principle	What it means in class
1	**Student talks 70% of the time**	If you are talking more than the student, stop. Time it once a week.
2	**Chunks, not rules**	Teach whole phrases ("Could I get…?", "I'm looking for…") as one block. Older adults learn blocks faster than rules.
3	**Situation first**	Every lesson is a real travel situation. The question is always: "What would you *say* here?"
4	**Repeat → Vary → Free**	Same phrase 3 ways: repeat it, change one word, then use it in an unscripted role-play.
5	**Correct smart, not everything**	During free talk, write mistakes down silently; correct 3–5 at the end. Correct on the spot only when meaning breaks.
6	**Survival tools before perfection**	Week 1 teaches how to say *"Sorry, could you repeat that more slowly?"* A student who can ask for help never fully gets stuck.
7	**Spiral**	Every week recycles the previous weeks. Week 12's final interview uses phrases from Week 1.

The "Portuguese bridge" rule

Use Portuguese **only** for: (a) explaining *why* something is wrong, (b) calming anxiety, (c) the first 5 minutes of Week 1. After Week 4, Portuguese is ≤ 5% of class. Make it a game: student pays "1 point" each time they switch to Portuguese without asking "How do you say ___ in English?" (which is *always* allowed — and is itself a phrase to practice).

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3. Before Week 1: the diagnostic session

30–45 minutes, free or low cost (also works as your sales meeting — see section 10).

Use the form in **File 5 (Student Sheets)**. It covers:

1. **Goals** (in Portuguese): Where are you going? When? Alone or with family? Is there an interview (visa, immigration, job)? What scares you most?
2. **Speaking sample** (in English, record audio with permission): 6 questions from easy to hard:
   - What's your name? Where are you from?
   - What do you do? / What did you do before you retired?
   - Tell me about your family.
   - What did you do last weekend? *(past tense test)*
   - Why do you want to travel to ___? *(opinion / reasons)*
   - What would you do if you lost your passport? *(hypothetical — most won't manage; that's fine)*
3. **Listening sample:** play 30 seconds of a natural airport or restaurant dialogue. Ask 3 simple questions.
4. **Pronunciation check:** ask them to read: *"I think three hotels have the best rooms. I worked, I visited, I played."* (tests TH, H/R, final -ed, vowel length.)

Score each area 1–5 using the rubric in section 7. Keep the recording — you'll play it back in Week 12. **This "before and after" moment is the single most powerful thing in the course** (and your best marketing, with permission).

Adapting the program:

- Very weak (can't answer the first 3 questions): spend 2 weeks on Phase 1 instead of 1 week per unit; drop Week 11.
- Stronger (handles past tense): compress Weeks 1–2 into one week; add more debate/free talk in Phase 3.
- Has a **specific date** (trip or interview): move the relevant week earlier and repeat its role-play every session until the date.

4. The 60-minute session template

Time	Block	What happens
0–5	**Warm-up chat**	"How was your day?" — real small talk. Note mistakes silently.
5–10	**Recycle**	Quick-fire review: 5 phrases from last class, student must say them fast.
10–25	**New chunks**	8–12 phrases for today's situation. Model → student repeats → student varies. Drill the pronunciation point of the week here.
25–45	**Role-play**	2–3 rounds of the situation. Round 1 with the phrase sheet. Round 2 without. Round 3 you add a "problem" (surprise).
45–55	**Free talk**	Open questions connected to the theme. Student talks, you listen and note.
55–60	**Feedback + homework**	3–5 corrections (write them in the student's notebook / WhatsApp), homework, and one compliment that is *specific and true*.

Golden rule for role-plays: you play the native speaker at *slightly faster than comfortable* speed, using real phrases ("Next, please!", "For here or to go?", "Can I see your passport?"). Speak naturally — don't use "teacher English". The student's job is to survive, not to be perfect.

Weekly rhythm (3 sessions):

- **Session A** — new situation, new chunks.
- **Session B** — same situation, harder role-plays + listening practice.
- **Session C** — "Mission day": mixed review, a longer role-play combining all weeks so far, and the weekly self-check.

5. Program map — 3 phases, 12 weeks

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PHASE 1 — UNLOCK (Weeks 1–4)        "I can say the basics without freezing"
  W1  Survival kit + Who am I?
  W2  My life, my family, my work
  W3  Airport: check-in, security, boarding
  W4  IMMIGRATION & PASSPORT CONTROL  ← checkpoint 1

PHASE 2 — TRAVEL (Weeks 5–8)        "I can handle every travel situation"
  W5  Hotel & accommodation
  W6  Restaurants, cafés, shopping
  W7  Getting around: directions, transport, Uber, tickets
  W8  Problems & emergencies: doctor, pharmacy, lost items  ← checkpoint 2

PHASE 3 — CONVERSE (Weeks 9–12)     "I can have a real conversation"
  W9   Small talk & making friends
  W10  Telling stories (the past) — the trip, my life
  W11  Opinions, plans, preferences — going deeper
  W12  Final interview + real-world mission + graduation  ← final assessment
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6. The 12 weeks, session by session

Each week lists: **Can-do goal · Core chunks · Pronunciation focus · Grammar-in-action (only what's needed) · Role-plays · Free-talk questions · Homework · Brazilian trap of the week.**

WEEK 1 — Survival Kit + Who Am I?

Can-do goal: "I can introduce myself and I never get stuck, because I can ask for help."

Core chunks — Survival kit (teach FIRST, drill every class for 12 weeks):

- Sorry, could you repeat that?
- Could you speak more slowly, please?
- What does ___ mean?
- How do you say ___ in English?
- Sorry, I don't understand. / I didn't catch that.
- Can you write it down, please?
- Just a moment, let me think.
- My English is not perfect, but I'll try.

Core chunks — Introductions:

- Hi, my name is ___. Nice to meet you. / Nice to meet you too.

- I'm from ___, in Brazil. I live in ___.
- I'm ___ years old. *(trap: NOT "I have ___ years")*
- I'm a ___ / I work as a ___ / I'm retired. I used to be a ___.
- I'm married / single / divorced / a widow(er). I have two kids and one grandchild.
- I'm learning English because I want to travel to ___.

Pronunciation focus: the "extra i" (epenthesis). Brazilians say *"Facebook-i"*, *"big-i"*, *"I like-i"*. Drill: *like, work, big, good, book, name, nice, Brazil* — stop the sound dead at the end.

Grammar-in-action: verb TO BE — *I'm / you're / he's / it's* (contracted, the way people talk).

Role-plays:

1. Meeting someone at a party.
2. The person sitting next to you on the plane.
3. *Surprise round:* the teacher talks too fast → the student must use 3 survival phrases.

Free talk: Where are you from? What's your city famous for? Why English, why now?

Homework: Record a 30-second voice message introducing yourself (send on WhatsApp). Write the **"My Story" card** (see **File 5 (Student Sheets)**) — 6 sentences about yourself, which will grow every week.

Brazilian trap: *"I have 55 years."* → **"I'm 55."** and *"I am agree"* → **"I agree."**

WEEK 2 — My Life, My Family, My Work

Can-do goal: "I can talk about myself for 1 minute and ask other people questions."

Core chunks:

- What do you do? / What do you do for a living? → I'm a nurse / I run a small business / I'm retired.
- Where do you work? → I work at a hospital / for a bank / from home.
- How long have you been retired? → For about five years.
- Do you have kids? → Yes, I have a son and a daughter. They're 30 and 27.
- My son lives in ___. That's why I'm traveling.
- What do you like to do in your free time? → I like to cook / walk / read / watch series.
- On weekends I usually ___.

- **Turning it back:** And you? / What about you? / How about you?

Pronunciation focus: H vs. R. Brazilian "R" at the start of a word sounds like English "H" (*"rice" → "hice"*). And English "H" is soft air, never a Portuguese "R". Drill pairs: *house / rouse, hot / rot, head / red, happy, hotel, rice, right, Rio.*

Grammar-in-action: present simple for routines + **do/does questions** (*Do you…? Does she…?*). Third-person -s: *she works, he lives*.

Role-plays:

1. Two travelers in a hotel lobby getting to know each other.
2. Speed-dating style: teacher asks 10 quick questions, student answers in ≤ 5 seconds each.
3. Student interviews the teacher (role swap — students rarely practice *asking*).

Free talk: Describe a normal day. What's your best family memory? What job did you love?

Homework: Add 6 sentences to "My Story" card (family + work + hobbies). Watch a 3-minute YouTube video of real people introducing themselves; write down 3 phrases you heard.

Brazilian trap: *"I work in a hospital since 2010."* → **"I've worked at a hospital since 2010."** (teach as a chunk, not as a tense lesson). *"My parents"* = pai e mãe only — not "parentes" (= **relatives**).

WEEK 3 — The Airport: Check-in, Security, Boarding

Can-do goal: "I can check in, go through security and get on my plane without help."

Core chunks — the student says:

- Hi, I'd like to check in. Here's my passport.
- I have one bag to check. / Just a carry-on.
- Could I have a window / an aisle seat, please?
- Is the flight on time? / Which gate is it?
- Where is gate 32? / Where's the restroom?
- Excuse me, is this the line for ___?
- I think I missed my connection. What should I do?

Core chunks — the student must UNDERSTAND (listening):

- *Next, please! / Next in line!*

- *Any bags to check? / Did you pack your bags yourself?*
- *Please put your liquids, laptops and shoes in the bin.*
- *Step forward / Arms up / You're good to go.*
- *Boarding group 3 is now boarding. | This is the final call for…*
- *Your flight has been delayed / canceled / the gate has changed.*

Pronunciation focus: numbers — 13 vs 30, 14 vs 40, 15 vs 50 (stress: thir**TEEN** vs **THIR**ty). Gate numbers, flight numbers, times. Also how people say times: *"ten-fifteen", "a quarter to nine"*.

Grammar-in-action: "I'd like…" and **"Could I…?"** — polite requests (the most useful structure for travel). Contrast with the too-direct *"I want…"*, which can sound rude.

Role-plays:

1. Check-in counter (teacher = agent).
2. Security line (teacher gives fast commands, student acts them out — TPR, great for older learners).
3. *Surprise:* "Your flight is canceled." Student must ask what to do, about another flight, and about a hotel voucher.

Listening: play real airport announcements (search "airport boarding announcement" on YouTube). Student writes the gate and time.

Homework: Learn the alphabet sound-by-sound for **spelling your name** (A/E/I and G/J are always confused by Brazilians). Practice spelling your full name and email out loud.

Brazilian trap: *"I want a window."* → **"Could I have a window seat?"** · *"Where is the bathroom?"* → in the US say **"restroom"**.

WEEK 4 — Immigration & Passport Control ⭐ CHECKPOINT 1

Can-do goal: "I can answer an immigration officer calmly, clearly and briefly."

> This is the week your students fear most. It is usually the reason they hired you. Spend extra time here and **recycle it in every later Session C**.

The 3 golden rules (tell the student in Portuguese):

1. **Answer short, true and direct.** No long stories. No jokes. No lies — ever.
2. **Answer exactly what was asked.** "How long?" → "Two weeks." Not your life story.

3. **If you don't understand, ask.** "Sorry, could you repeat that?" is 100% acceptable. Guessing is not.

Core chunks — typical questions and model answers: | Officer asks | Model answer | |---|---| | What's the purpose of your visit? | Tourism. / I'm visiting my daughter. / For a conference. | | How long are you staying? | Two weeks. I go back on May 20th. | | Where are you staying? | At the Hilton in Orlando. / At my son's house in Boston. | | Who are you traveling with? | With my wife. / I'm traveling alone. | | What do you do in Brazil? | I'm a retired teacher. / I own a small store. | | Have you been here before? | Yes, once, in 2019. / No, this is my first time. | | Do you have a return ticket? | Yes, here it is. | | How much money are you bringing? | About two thousand dollars, and my credit card. | | Anything to declare? / Any food? | No, nothing. / Yes, I have some chocolates. | | Do you know anyone here? | Yes, my son lives here. He's a ___. |

Important real-world note for the student: At the **US consulate in Brazil**, the visa interview can usually be done in Portuguese — confirm when booking. But at **airport immigration abroad (e.g., US CBP), the conversation is in English.** That is where this week pays off. Always carry printed documents: return ticket, hotel booking / host's address, proof of ties (job, retirement, property) — and say "Here it is" while handing it over.

Pronunciation focus: dates and months — *May twentieth, August third*. Ordinals (1st, 2nd, 3rd, 20th). And **TH** — *third, thirtieth, thank you, three* (tongue between teeth; NOT "f", "t" or "s").

Role-plays: use **File 4 (Question Bank)**. Run 3 officer "personalities": **friendly**, **neutral and fast**, and **serious/suspicious** (lots of follow-up: *"Why two weeks?" "What does your son do?" "Who paid for the ticket?"*). The serious one is where students grow.

CHECKPOINT 1 (Session C): a recorded 5-minute immigration interview + 2-minute self-introduction. Score with the rubric. Compare with the diagnostic.

Brazilian trap: answering "Do you have…?" with just "Have" → **"Yes, I do."** And *"I'm going to stay 15 days"* (fine) — but **"two weeks"** sounds more natural.

WEEK 5 — Hotel & Accommodation

Can-do goal: "I can check in, ask for what I need, and complain politely."

Core chunks:

- Hi, I have a reservation under the name ___.

- I booked a double room for 5 nights.
- What time is breakfast? / Is breakfast included?
- What's the Wi-Fi password?
- Could I have a late check-out? / Can I leave my bags here?
- **Complaining politely:** *I'm sorry to bother you, but…* the air conditioning isn't working / the room is too noisy / there are no towels.
- Would it be possible to change rooms?
- Could you call a taxi for me? / Can you recommend a good restaurant nearby?
- Airbnb: *What time can I check in? How do I get the key? Where do I leave the trash?*

Pronunciation focus: vowel length — *ship / sheep, sit / seat, live / leave, full / fool*. "I want to **leave**" vs "I want to **live**" causes real confusion at hotels! Also the dangerous pairs **sheet / beach / piece** — make the long vowel clearly long.

Grammar-in-action: "There is / there are" + "isn't / aren't" (describing problems). **"Would it be possible…?"** as a chunk.

Role-plays:

1. Check-in at a hotel (teacher asks for card, ID, explains breakfast and elevator).
2. Calling the front desk with a problem.
3. *Surprise:* "Sorry, we don't have your reservation." Student must stay calm, show confirmation, ask for a solution.

Homework: Watch a hotel check-in dialogue on YouTube twice — first with subtitles, then without. Shadow it (repeat right after the speaker, see section 9).

Brazilian trap: *"I want to make a reclamation."* → **"I'd like to make a complaint."** · *"Push"* on doors means **empurre** (not "puxe" — that's *pull*).

WEEK 6 — Restaurants, Cafés & Shopping

Can-do goal: "I can order food, ask about the menu, pay, and shop for clothes or souvenirs."

Core chunks — restaurant:

- A table for two, please. / We have a reservation.
- Could we see the menu? / What do you recommend?
- What comes with that? / Is it spicy?
- I'll have the ___. / Could I get the ___, please?
- Can I have it without onions? / I'm allergic to ___.
- **Could we get the check, please?** (US) / **the bill** (UK)

- Is the tip included?

Listening — fast phrases they WILL hear:

- *For here or to go?* · *What can I get you?* · *Anything else?* · *How would you like your steak?* · *Still or sparkling?* · *Are you still working on that?* (= have you finished?) · *Do you want a box?* · *Paper or plastic?*

Core chunks — shopping:

- I'm just looking, thanks.
- Do you have this in a medium / in blue / in a bigger size?
- Can I try it on? Where are the fitting rooms?
- How much is this? / Is this on sale?
- Can I pay by card? / Do you take cash?
- I'd like to return this. I have the receipt.

Culture note: tipping in the US is 15–20% at sit-down restaurants and is expected, not optional. Sales tax is added at the register (the price tag is not the final price). Students are always surprised — explain both.

Pronunciation focus: final -ED — *worked (t), played (d), wanted (id)*. Brazilians say "work-ed" for all. Drill: *I ordered, I asked, I wanted, I liked, I paid.*

Role-plays:

1. Coffee shop counter (teacher speaks VERY fast, like a real barista).
2. Sit-down restaurant: order, special request, wrong dish arrives, ask for the check.
3. Clothing store: wrong size, exchange, payment.

Homework: Order something in English for real if possible (online menu, or a voice note pretending to order from a real US restaurant menu found online).

Brazilian trap: *"I'm going to take a coffee."* → **"I'll have a coffee."** / *"Can I get a coffee?"* · *"exquisite"* ≠ esquisito (= **weird/strange**). *"Lunch"* is almoço, not lanche (= **snack**).

WEEK 7 — Getting Around: Directions, Transport, Uber, Tickets

Can-do goal: "I can find my way, buy tickets, use transport, and ask strangers for directions."

Core chunks:

- Excuse me, how do I get to ___? / Is it far from here?

- Is there a subway station / a pharmacy near here?
- Can I walk there? How long does it take?
- **Understanding directions:** go straight · turn left/right · it's on your left · at the corner · two blocks down · across from · next to · you can't miss it.
- A one-way / round-trip ticket to ___, please.
- Which platform? / Does this train go to ___? / Which stop do I get off at?
- **Uber/taxi:** Hi, are you ___ (driver's name)? / Could you take me to this address? / Could you turn on the air, please? / You can drop me off here.
- Renting a car: I have a reservation. Is insurance included? Where do I return it? What kind of gas does it take?

Pronunciation focus: word stress and linking — how natives connect words: *"Turn_it off", "Get_out", "Take_a left", "What_are you..."* → *"Whaddaya"*. This is a **listening** focus: students understand slow English but not connected English.

Grammar-in-action: imperatives (*Go, Turn, Take*) and **"How do I...?" / "Where can I...?"**

Role-plays:

1. Map role-play: use Google Maps on screen; teacher gives directions, student traces the route.
2. Swap: student gives directions to the teacher-tourist.
3. Subway ticket machine / station attendant.
4. *Surprise:* the Uber driver is going the wrong way / the train is canceled.

Homework: "Virtual walk": open Google Street View in a city you'll visit. Record yourself describing the route from your hotel to a landmark.

Brazilian trap: *"I'm going to catch an Uber"* (OK!) — but *"I lost the bus"* → **"I missed the bus."** · *"Pretend"* = fingir (not "pretender" → **intend / plan**).

WEEK 8 — Problems & Emergencies ⭐ CHECKPOINT 2

Can-do goal: "If something goes wrong, I can explain it and get help."

Core chunks — health:

- I don't feel well. / I need to see a doctor.
- I have a headache / a stomachache / a fever / a sore throat.
- My ___ hurts. / It hurts here.
- It started yesterday. / It's getting worse.
- I take medication for blood pressure / diabetes. *(prepare the student's real medication list in English!)*

- I'm allergic to penicillin.
- **Pharmacy:** Do I need a prescription for this? How many should I take? / Can you recommend something for ___?

Core chunks — problems:

- I lost my passport / wallet / phone. / Someone stole my bag.
- Where is the nearest police station? / I need to report a theft.
- I need to call the Brazilian consulate.
- Help! / Call 911! *(US — and know the number for each country they'll visit)*
- Can I use your phone? My battery died.
- My card isn't working. / The ATM kept my card.
- My luggage didn't arrive. *(lost baggage claim)*

Pronunciation focus: review of all previous points in emergency phrases — under stress, students go back to Portuguese habits. Practice saying these **fast and under pressure**.

Role-plays:

1. Doctor / urgent care: describe symptoms, history, allergies.
2. Pharmacy counter.
3. Police report for a stolen bag (who, what, when, where).
4. Lost luggage desk at the airport.

CHECKPOINT 2 (Session C): "Bad day" chain role-play — 15 minutes, no phrase sheet: luggage lost → hotel problem → feeling sick → pharmacy. Score with rubric.

Homework: Create a personal **Emergency Card** in English (blood type, medications, allergies, emergency contact, hotel address, insurance phone). The student should actually carry it on the trip.

Brazilian trap: *"I'm with headache"* → **"I have a headache."** · *"I'm constipated"* — be careful! In English it means *intestine preso*, not a cold. A cold is **"I have a cold / I'm congested."** (This one creates very funny moments at pharmacies — teach it.)

WEEK 9 — Small Talk & Making Friends

Can-do goal: "I can start, keep and finish a casual conversation with a stranger."

Core chunks — the 3 parts of small talk:

- **Start:** Beautiful day, isn't it? / Is this your first time here? / Where are you from? / I love your ___. / Is this seat taken?

- **Keep it going:** Oh really? / That's interesting! / How was it? / What do you like most about ___? / Me too! / Me neither.
- **Finish politely:** Well, it was really nice talking to you. / I have to go, but enjoy your trip! / Have a good one!
- **Safe topics:** weather, the trip, food, the city, family, sports (football = soccer in the US!), travel.
- **Topics to avoid with strangers:** money, salary, age, weight, religion, politics.

Pronunciation focus: intonation — Brazilians often sound flat or "angry" in English. Practice rising intonation for interest (*"Oh, really?"* ↗) and the friendly falling-rising tone of *"That's nice!"*

Grammar-in-action: tag questions as chunks (*isn't it? / aren't you? / don't you?*) and **follow-up questions** — the skill that makes a conversation last.

Role-plays:

1. Waiting in line at a museum.
2. Breakfast at the hotel — another guest sits at your table.
3. A tour group / cruise dinner table.
4. **"Keep it alive" game:** teacher answers with short replies; the student must keep the conversation going for 3 minutes using follow-up questions.

Free talk: Brazil questions foreigners always ask — *What's Brazil like? Is it safe? What should I eat there? Do you dance samba?* Prepare 30-second answers about **your own city and Brazilian culture** — they WILL be asked.

Homework: Talk to one real English speaker (online language exchange app, a tourist in your city, an international video call). Report back in class.

Brazilian trap: *"Actually"* = na verdade (NOT "atualmente" → **currently / nowadays**). *"Eventually"* = finalmente / com o tempo (NOT "eventualmente" → **occasionally**).

WEEK 10 — Telling Stories: Talking About the Past

Can-do goal: "I can tell a story — what happened on my trip, a memory, my life."

Core chunks — story connectors (more important than grammar!):

- First… Then… After that… Finally…
- So… / Because… / But… / Suddenly…
- The best part was… / The funny thing is…
- It was amazing / terrible / unforgettable.

- **Listener reactions:** No way! / Seriously? / What happened next? / That's crazy!

Grammar-in-action: simple past — but only the **25 most common irregular verbs** as chunks: *went, had, saw, ate, took, got, made, came, gave, said, told, felt, found, bought, left, met, paid, spent, thought, knew, slept, drove, flew, wrote, lost.* Use them in mini-stories, not lists.

- Past questions: *Did you…? Where did you go? What did you see?*
- **"used to"** for life memories: *When I was young, I used to…*

Pronunciation focus: final **-ED** again (recycle from W6) + irregular verbs that Brazilians mispronounce: *bought, thought, caught* (no "ou" sound), *said* ("sed", not "say-d").

Role-plays:

1. **"How was your trip?"** — friend back home asks about every detail.
2. **"Tell me about your life"** — the student tells their life story in 3 minutes (prepared, then improvised with interruptions).
3. Photo story: student brings 5 real photos from their phone and tells the story behind each.

Homework: Record a 2-minute story: "The best trip of my life" or "A funny thing that happened to me". Send on WhatsApp; you give audio feedback with 3 points.

Brazilian trap: *"I was in Paris last year and I knowed…"* → **"I went to Paris last year and I met…"** · *"Yesterday I go"* — Brazilians forget the past form when nervous. Drill with "yesterday / last week / ago".

WEEK 11 — Opinions, Plans & Preferences

Can-do goal: "I can give my opinion, talk about plans, agree and disagree politely."

Core chunks:

- **Opinions:** I think… / In my opinion… / For me… / I'm not sure, but…
- **Agree / disagree:** I agree. / Exactly! / I see your point, but… / I'm not so sure about that.
- **Preferences:** I prefer ___ to ___. / I'd rather ___. / I'm (not) a big fan of ___.
- **Plans:** I'm going to visit… / I'm planning to… / I'd love to… / I'm thinking about…
- **Comparing:** It's bigger / cheaper / more expensive / better than… / The best ___ I've ever…
- **Hypothetical (light):** If I had more time, I would… / What would you do if…?

Grammar-in-action: going to (plans) vs **will** (decisions now / promises); comparatives & superlatives as chunks; **"would"** for wishes.

Role-plays:

1. **Planning a day trip** with a travel companion: you disagree on where to go; negotiate.
2. **Travel agent:** compare two packages, ask questions, choose.
3. **Mini-debate** (gentle topics): beach or mountains? Cruise or road trip? Big city or small town? Is it better to travel young or old?

Free talk: Where would you live if you could live anywhere? What's on your bucket list? How has your city changed?

Homework: Prepare a 2-minute talk: "My dream trip" (where, why, plan, budget, who with).

Brazilian trap: *"Do you want that I help you?"* → **"Do you want me to help you?"** · *"I'm thinking in going"* → **"I'm thinking about going."** · *"Depends"* → **"It depends."**

WEEK 12 — Final Interview, Real-World Mission & Graduation ⭐ FINAL

Can-do goal: "I can handle a full trip and a full conversation in English."

Session A — Mega review: 30-minute "Full Trip Simulation" with no phrase sheets: check-in → immigration → Uber → hotel → restaurant → problem → small talk. Teacher changes character every 5 minutes.

Session B — Real-World Mission: the student completes **one real** interaction in English, live:

- a video call with a native/fluent friend of yours (arrange in advance — a 10-minute "interview" with a real stranger is the best final test there is), OR
- calling a real US/UK hotel or store with a real question (opening hours, prices), OR
- a recorded conversation with a tourist in the student's city.

Session C — Final assessment & graduation:

1. Recorded **final interview** (15 min): self-introduction (2 min) + immigration interview (5 min) + story (3 min) + free conversation (5 min).
2. Score with the rubric — compare with Diagnostic and Checkpoints 1 & 2.
3. **Play the Day 1 recording, then today's.** (Prepare tissues. Seriously.)

4. Give the certificate (see **File 5 (Student Sheets)**) and a personalized **"Next 3 months on your own"** plan: daily shadowing, 1 series to watch with English subtitles, 1 conversation per week, review of the "My Story" card.
5. Ask for a testimonial (written or video) and for referrals.

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7. Assessment & progress tracking

Speaking rubric (score 1–5 per area, use at Diagnostic, W4, W8, W12)

Area	1	3	5
Fluency / confidence	Freezes, long silences, switches to Portuguese	Pauses but continues; uses "let me think"	Speaks steadily, recovers from mistakes alone
Comprehension	Needs everything repeated slowly	Understands at moderate speed, asks for repetition sometimes	Understands natural speed in familiar situations
Vocabulary / chunks	Isolated words	Uses course chunks in prepared situations	Uses chunks flexibly in unexpected situations
Accuracy	Errors block meaning	Errors are frequent but meaning is clear	Few errors, rarely affect meaning
Pronunciation	Often not understood	Understood with some effort	Easily understood; Brazilian accent is fine!
Interaction	Only answers, never asks	Asks simple questions back	Keeps the conversation going, reacts naturally

Total /30. Typical journey: Diagnostic 8–12 → W4 13–16 → W8 17–20 → W12 20–25.

> **Accent is not a mistake.** The goal is to be *understood*, not to sound American. Tell students this explicitly — it removes a lot of fear.

Weekly self-check (student, 2 minutes, end of Session C)

"This week I can…" — 3 can-do statements with 😟 / 🙂 / 😄. See **File 5 (Student Sheets)**.

Teacher's log (per session, 2 lines)

Date · what we did · 3 errors noted · 1 win · next focus. Keeping this makes you look (and be) very professional, and it's the source of your feedback messages.

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8. Teaching older adults — what works

- **Lower anxiety first.** Many had bad school experiences with English. Say early: "Mistakes are the price of speaking. In here, mistakes are free."
- **Use their life.** They have 40+ years of stories, jobs and opinions — use them. Never use children's materials or childish topics.
- **Slower pace for new input, but many repetitions.** Memory works best with spaced repetition: review each chunk 1 day, 3 days, 1 week, 2 weeks later (the "Recycle" block does this).
- **Physical and visual.** Big-font printed phrase sheets, real objects (passport, menu, boarding pass printouts), acting out situations standing up.
- **Hearing:** check if they hear you well (online: headphones are mandatory). Speak clearly, face the camera.
- **Technology:** help them set up WhatsApp audio, YouTube subtitles, Google Translate's conversation mode as a *backup* — explain everything simply.
- **Celebrate concrete wins.** "Last month you couldn't answer that question. Today you answered in 3 seconds." Specific praise works; general praise doesn't.
- **Respect their pace with a deadline.** If a trip date exists, focus ruthlessly on what that trip needs.

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9. Homework system (15 min/day)

Older adults with a busy life do homework when it's **short, clear and daily**. Send it on WhatsApp after each class.

Day	15-minute task
Mon	Review the phrase sheet out loud (not silently!) — 3 times
Tue	**Shadowing:** play a 1-minute dialogue; repeat each sentence right after the speaker, copying speed and melody
Wed	Record a voice message using 5 phrases of the week
Thu	Watch 10 min of a series/YouTube in English with **English** subtitles; write 3 phrases

Day	15-minute task
Fri	Update the "My Story" card and read it aloud
Sat/Sun	Free: talk to yourself in English while doing chores ("Now I'm cooking rice...")

Suggested free resources (check that they're still available before recommending): YouTube channels with real-life travel dialogues, podcasts for learners at slow speed, the subtitles feature on Netflix/YouTube, language-exchange apps for Week 9.

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10. Running this as a business

> Practical notes for Di. Prices below are a *framework*, not market data — check what other private teachers in your city / on platforms charge before deciding.

Offer structure (example):

- **Free diagnostic** (30–45 min) — this is your sales meeting. At the end, show them their score and the 12-week map, and what they'll be able to do.
- **Full program** — 36 sessions, 12 weeks, paid monthly (3 payments) or upfront with a discount.
- **Express "Trip in 4 weeks"** — Weeks 1, 3, 4, 5–8 compressed (for students with a close trip date).
- **Interview-only package** — 6 sessions of mock interviews (immigration / job interview in English).
- **Pairs** (couples traveling together!) — slightly higher total price, lower per person. Couples are a great niche for this program.

Where students come from:

- Your own network in Brazil: family, friends, church, community groups, WhatsApp groups of retirees.
- Travel agencies — offer a partnership: "your clients travel more confidently".
- Facebook / Instagram posts with (permitted) before/after audio clips.
- Online: Zoom/Google Meet allows you to teach from anywhere — Brazil or the US.

Your strongest selling point: you are a Brazilian who **lived and worked in the US for years** in healthcare — you've actually been through the airport, the immigration line, the doctor's office and the job interview in English. You understand exactly where Brazilians get stuck because you've been there. Say that in every pitch.

Materials you'll need (all included in these files or easy to make): phrase sheets per week (print from this book), the student forms, a video-call setup with good audio, a WhatsApp group or chat per student for homework.

Speak to Travel — EXPRESS: 1-Month Conversation Boost

> **Teacher's book**: the short version of **File 1 (3-Month Program)**. **Students:** Portuguese speakers who **already know English** (they read it, understand a lot, studied grammar) but are **bad at conversation**: they freeze, speak slowly, translate in their heads, can't follow fast speech, or give one-word answers. **Duration:** 4 weeks · 3 sessions per week · 60 minutes = **12 sessions**. **Rule of this program:** the student talks **80%** of the time. There's very little new content and a lot of speaking.

Contents

1. Who this is for (and who it's NOT for)
2. What's different from the 12-week program
3. Session 0: diagnostic (before day 1)
4. The 60-minute Express session
5. The 5 fluency tools
6. The 4 weeks, session by session
7. Assessment
8. Daily homework (20 min)
9. Selling the Express version

Uses the same companion files:

- **File 3 (Error Guide)**: error guide (pronunciation, false friends, translated sentences)
- **File 4 (Question Bank)**: role-play question bank
- **File 5 (Student Sheets)**: diagnostic form, "My Story" card, emergency card, certificate

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1. Who this is for (and who it's NOT for)

Good fit (use the 6-question diagnostic in section 3):

- Answers basic questions (name, work, family) without much trouble
- Understands slow English well, but gets lost at native speed

- Knows the past tense "on paper" but doesn't use it when speaking
- Says things like: *"Eu entendo tudo, mas na hora de falar trava."* ("I understand everything, but when it's time to speak I freeze.")

Not a good fit, so offer the 12-week program instead:

- Can't answer "What do you do?" or "Tell me about your family"
- Needs most questions repeated in Portuguese

Be honest about this in the first meeting. A weak student in a fast program gets frustrated and quits, and that hurts your reputation.

The promise:

> "In 4 weeks you'll go from 'I understand but I can't speak' to holding a real 10-minute conversation, at normal speed, without freezing. You'll handle any travel situation and an interview with confidence."

The honest limit: one month won't fix every grammar mistake or change the accent. It fixes the **speaking block**, which is usually the student's real problem.

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2. What's different from the 12-week program

	12 weeks	Express (1 month)
Starting level	Knows a little English	**Knows English, can't speak it**
Main problem attacked	Lack of phrases + fear	**Blocking, slowness, translating, listening speed**
New content	Lots of phrases per week	**Few phrases. Practice using what they already know**
Travel situations	1 per week	**All in one week (W2), at native speed**
Student talking time	70%	**80%**
Correction	Gentle	**More direct. They can take it**
Homework	15 min/day	**20 min/day, all of it speaking**

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3. Session 0: diagnostic (before day 1)

30 minutes, free. Use the form in **File 5 (Student Sheets)**, but go harder:

1. **Goals (in Portuguese):** Trip? Interview? Work? Date? What happens when you try to speak?
2. **Speaking (record it):**
   - Tell me about yourself. *(Ask for 2 minutes. Most will stop after 20 seconds, and that tells you a lot.)*
   - What did you do last weekend? Tell me everything.
   - Describe your city to someone who's never been there.
   - What's better: traveling alone or with family? Why?
   - What would you do if your flight was canceled?
   - Tell me about a difficult moment in your life or work.
3. **Listening at native speed:** play 1 minute of a real conversation (a podcast or a TV interview, not a learner video). Ask 3 questions.
4. **Measure:** how many seconds before they start answering? Do they give one-word answers? Do they ask you anything back?

Score with the rubric in section 7. **Keep the recording.** You'll play it in Session 12.

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4. The 60-minute Express session

Time	Block	What happens
0–5	**Warm-up**	Real small talk at **normal speed**. No slowing down.
5–15	**Fluency drill**	One of the 5 fluency tools (section 5), usually the 4-3-2.
15–20	**Toolbox**	5–8 phrases or "conversation moves" for today. Quick, no long explanations.
20–45	**Role-plays / discussion**	Long, unscripted, with surprises. Teacher plays natives at natural speed.
45–55	**Error clinic**	Show the 5 mistakes you noted. Student corrects them **out loud**. Then repeat a piece of the role-play correctly.
55–60	**Homework + 1 specific win**	Send it on WhatsApp right after class.

Correction style: during the role-play, don't stop the student. Write the mistakes down. In the error clinic, write each mistake as the student said it and ask *"What's wrong here?"* Students at this level can usually fix it themselves, and fixing it themselves is what makes it stick.

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5. The 5 fluency tools

These are the core of the Express program. Use one or two in every session.

Tool 1 — 4-3-2

The student talks about one topic for **4 minutes**. Then the **same topic for 3 minutes**, then again for **2 minutes**. Each round they say the same content faster and more smoothly. It's a well-known fluency exercise, and the student can feel the improvement in a single session.

Tool 2 — Buy time (fillers)

Brazilians go silent when they're thinking, and in English a long silence feels uncomfortable. Teach natural "thinking sounds":

- *Well... / Let me think... / That's a good question... / How can I put this... / I mean... / You know... / Actually...*
- Ban "é..." and "tipo..." in class. The student pays 1 point every time they use one.

Tool 3 — Paraphrase (when the word is missing)

Don't stop the conversation because you don't know one word. Go around it:

- *It's a kind of... / It's something you use to... / It's like a... but... / I don't know the word, but it's the thing that...*
- **Game, "Forbidden Word":** describe an object (a word on a card) without saying it. The teacher guesses.

Tool 4 — Shadowing

Play 1 minute of real native speech. The student repeats **right behind the speaker**, about half a second later, copying the speed, the melody and the way words connect. This trains both listening and speaking at the same time.

Tool 5 — Follow-up questions (ask back)

Students who know English often answer well and then stop. Every answer should end with a question back:

- *And you? / What about you? / Have you ever...? / How was it? / Why did you...? / What was the best part?*

- **Rule in class:** any answer without a question back is "incomplete" (except in immigration interviews, where you answer short and don't ask back).

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6. The 4 weeks, session by session

```
WEEK 1 — UNBLOCK         "I start speaking right away and I don't stop"
WEEK 2 — TRAVEL AT REAL SPEED   "I handle every travel situation, even with
surprises"
WEEK 3 — KEEP IT ALIVE   "I can have a real back-and-forth conversation"
WEEK 4 — GO DEEPER + FINAL  "I give opinions, tell stories, pass an interview"
```

WEEK 1 — UNBLOCK

Session 1 — Fluency over perfection

- **Talk with the student (in Portuguese, 3 min):** in conversation, being understood matters more than being correct. Mistakes are allowed. Silence is the real problem.
- **Fluency drill:** 4-3-2 on *"Tell me about yourself."*
- **Toolbox:** fillers (Tool 2) + the survival phrases: *Sorry, could you repeat that? / What do you mean by...? / Could you say that in a different way?*
- **Role-play:** "Speed questions". The teacher fires 20 personal questions and the student must start answering in **under 3 seconds**.
- **Homework:** record a 2-minute voice message: "Tell me about yourself." Start the "My Story" card.

Session 2 — When you don't know the word

- **Fluency drill:** 4-3-2 on *"Describe your city / your house."*
- **Toolbox:** paraphrasing (Tool 3).
- **Activities:** Forbidden Word game (10 cards). Then "Describe the picture": the student describes a busy photo in detail for 3 minutes.
- **Error clinic:** focus on the classic "translated" sentences from **File 3 (Error Guide)** that this student makes.
- **Homework:** "Talk to yourself" for 5 minutes a day: describe what you're doing in English while cooking or driving.

Session 3 — Listening at native speed

- **Fluency drill:** shadowing (Tool 4) with a 1-minute dialogue.

- **Toolbox: connected speech**, meaning how natives really say it: *gonna, wanna, gotta, "whaddaya", "didja", "lemme", "kinda"*, and words that run together (*"turn_it_off", "pick_it_up"*).
- **Activity:** "Real-speed dictation". The teacher says 10 fast sentences and the student writes them, then says them at the same speed.
- **Free talk (15 min):** what are your goals for this month? What was hardest this week?
- **Self-check** (fichas, sheet 3). Record a short audio sample for comparison.

WEEK 2 — TRAVEL AT REAL SPEED

> The student "knows" travel English already. This week is about doing it **fast, with surprises**, and without the phrase sheet. Use **File 4 (Question Bank)**.

Session 4 — Airport + immigration

- **Warm-up:** quick review of the polite requests *Could I... / I'd like... / Would it be possible...* (instead of *"I want..."*).
- **Role-plays:** check-in → security (fast commands) → **immigration** with the 3 officer types: friendly, neutral-fast and serious (bank section 1).
- **Immigration rules (say them in Portuguese):** short, true, direct answers. Answer only what was asked. Don't fill silences.
- **Surprise:** flight canceled → rebooking at the counter.
- **Homework:** prepare **your own true answers** to the 10 most common immigration questions. Record them as audio.

Session 5 — Hotel + restaurant + shopping

- **Fluency drill:** shadowing a real fast barista / waiter dialogue.
- **Toolbox:** polite complaints: *I'm sorry to bother you, but... / I think there's a mistake... / Would it be possible to...?*
- **Role-plays (with problem cards):** hotel check-in → wrong room → restaurant with a fast waiter → wrong dish → split the check and tip → return an item at a store.
- **Culture:** in the US, a 15–20% tip is expected, and sales tax is added when you pay.
- **Homework:** watch a real travel vlog in English (10 min, English subtitles) and write 5 phrases you'd use.

Session 6 — Problems & emergencies + "Full Trip"

- **Role-plays:** doctor (symptoms, medication, allergies), pharmacy, stolen bag / police report, lost luggage.
- **Big role-play (20 min): "Full Trip Simulation"**. Airport → immigration → Uber → hotel → restaurant → feeling sick → pharmacy. The teacher changes character every 3–4 minutes. No preparation and no phrase sheet.
- **Homework:** make the Emergency Card (fichas, sheet 4). **Checkpoint:** score the Full Trip with the rubric.

WEEK 3 — KEEP THE CONVERSATION ALIVE

Session 7 — Small talk that doesn't die

- **Fluency drill:** 4-3-2 on *"Your last trip."*
- **Toolbox:** follow-up questions (Tool 5) + reactions: *Oh really? / No way! / That's amazing! / Me too / Me neither / That makes sense.*
- **Small talk in 3 parts:** start (*Is this your first time here? / Beautiful day, isn't it?*), keep it going (follow-ups), finish (*It was great talking to you. Enjoy your trip!*).
- **Game, "Keep it alive":** the teacher gives short, boring answers. The student must keep the conversation going for 5 minutes.
- **Homework:** prepare 30-second answers to *"What's Brazil like? Is it safe? What should I eat there?"* Foreigners always ask these.

Session 8 — Telling stories

- **Fluency drill:** shadowing a short story from a podcast.
- **Toolbox:** story connectors: *So... / Then... / Suddenly... / Anyway... / The funny thing is... / Long story short...* Also the past-tense verbs they know but avoid: *went, got, took, saw, told, felt, bought, thought.*
- **Activity, "Photo stories":** the student brings 5 real photos from their phone and tells the story behind each one. The teacher interrupts with questions (*Wait, who was that? Then what happened?*).
- **Error clinic focus:** using the present when they mean the past (*"yesterday I go"*), and the final **-ED** pronunciation.
- **Homework:** record "The best (or worst) trip of my life" in 3 minutes.

Session 9 — Real conversation practice

- **This session is almost all free conversation (40 min)** on topics the student picks from a list: work, family, food, travel, movies or series, sports,

city life vs. country life, technology, health, dreams.
- **The teacher acts like a real conversation partner:** shares their own opinions, interrupts naturally, changes the subject, makes jokes. Not "teacher mode".
- **Last 15 min:** error clinic + self-check.
- **Optional real-world mission:** before Session 12, the student talks with a real English speaker. That could be a friend of yours on a video call, a language-exchange app, or a tourist.

WEEK 4 — GO DEEPER + FINAL

Session 10 — Opinions & discussion

- **Fluency drill:** 4-3-2 on *"Something you would change in your city."*
- **Toolbox:** *I think... / In my opinion... / I see your point, but... / I'm not so sure about that / It depends / On the other hand... / I'd rather...*
- **Mini-debates (the teacher takes the opposite side on purpose):** beach vs. mountains · cruise vs. road trip · big city vs. small town · is social media good or bad? · is it better to travel young or older?
- **Hypothetical:** *If I could live anywhere, I'd... / What would you do if...?*
- **Homework:** prepare a 2-minute talk: "My dream trip" or "A change I'd like to make in my life."

Session 11 — Interview day

- **Pick the interview the student actually needs:**
  - **Immigration/border:** the "serious officer" version, longer, with lots of follow-ups.
  - **Job interview in English:** *Tell me about yourself / Strengths and weaknesses / A difficult problem you solved (STAR: Situation, Task, Action, Result) / Do you have any questions for us?* (bank section 9)
  - **Social interview:** meeting a friend's family, a dinner party.
- **Run it twice.** Round 1, then feedback, then Round 2. Compare the two.
- **Homework:** do your preparation and get a good night's sleep. Tomorrow is the final.

Session 12 — Final assessment & graduation

1. **Final recorded conversation (25 min):** "Tell me about yourself" (2 min) → immigration interview (5 min) → a story (3 min) → opinion debate (5 min) → free conversation (10 min).
2. **Score with the rubric** and compare with the diagnostic.

3. **Play the diagnostic recording, then today's.**
4. **Certificate** (fichas, sheet 5. Change it to "Express: 12 sessions").
5. **"Keep going on your own" plan:** shadow 10 min a day, watch one series with English subtitles, have one conversation a week, re-read the My Story card.
6. **Offer the next step:** a monthly maintenance plan (for example, 1–2 classes a week) or more Express months with new topics. Ask for a testimonial and referrals.

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7. Assessment

Use the same **6-area rubric (score 1–5, total /30)** from **File 1 (3-Month Program)** section 7: Fluency · Comprehension · Vocabulary · Accuracy · Pronunciation · Interaction.

Check at: Session 0 (diagnostic) → Session 6 (Full Trip checkpoint) → Session 12 (final).

Also measure these numbers. Students love seeing them improve: | Measure | Session 0 | Session 12 | |---|---|---| | "Tell me about yourself" before they stop (seconds) | | | | Seconds before they start answering | | | | Times they switched to Portuguese in 10 min | | | | Follow-up questions they asked in 5 min of small talk | | |

Typical journey for this level: about 14–17 at the diagnostic → about 19–23 at the final.

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8. Daily homework (20 min)

All homework is **speaking**. Send it on WhatsApp after each class.

Every day	Task
5 min	**Shadowing** a 1-minute real audio clip (podcast, series, vlog)
5 min	**Talk to yourself** in English: describe your day or what you're doing
10 min	**Voice message to the teacher** on the topic of the week. The teacher replies with a short audio and 2–3 corrections.

The voice messages matter most. Hearing their own voice improve week after week is what keeps students motivated.

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9. Selling the Express version

- **Who buys it:** people with a trip or interview coming soon, people who "studied English for years but can't speak", former students of English courses, professionals.
- **Package:** 12 sessions in 1 month, paid upfront. Charge a bit more per hour than the 12-week program (it's more intensive and needs more preparation), or the same per hour with no discount. **Check what other teachers in your area charge first.**
- **After the month:** offer a **monthly maintenance plan** (1–2 classes a week). That's where the steady income is.
- **Upgrade path:** someone who fails the Session 0 diagnostic → offer the 12-week program instead.
- **Pitch line:** *"Você já sabe inglês. Em um mês, você vai conseguir FALAR inglês."* ("You already know English. In one month, you'll be able to SPEAK English.")

The Brazilian Speaker's Error Guide

> Companion to **File 1 (3-Month Program)**. These are the mistakes Portuguese speakers make most, with the fix and a quick drill for each. **Teacher tip:** don't teach this as a list. Use it to *recognize* errors during free talk, then pick the 3–5 that matter most for each student.

1. Pronunciation — the "Big 8"

#	Problem	What Brazilians do	Fix	Drill
1	**Extra "i" at the end**	*big-i, like-i, Facebook-i, hot-dog-i*	Stop the sound. Close the mouth / hold the tongue.	*big, book, like, stop, good, work, nice, Brazil*
2	**TH**	*"tank you"*, *"fank you"*, *"sree"*	Tongue lightly between the teeth, blow air	*think, three, thank, Thursday, third, mouth · the, this, that, mother*
3	**Initial R / H**	*rice → "hice"*; *hotel → "rotel"* (with Portuguese R)	English R: tongue curled back, doesn't touch anything. English H: just soft air	*red/head, rice, right, Rio · house, hotel, happy, help*
4	**Final -ED**	*work-ed, play-ed, ask-ed*	3 sounds: /t/ worked · /d/ played · /id/ only after t/d: wanted, needed	*I asked, I liked, I stopped · I called, I stayed · I visited, I waited*
5	**Vowel length**	*ship = sheep, live = leave, full = fool*	Long vowels are LONG and tense; short ones relaxed	*sit/seat, live/leave, fill/feel, pull/pool · beach, sheet, piece* (keep long!)
6	**Final M / N**	*"time"* sounds like *"taym"*, *"I'm"* like *"aim"* nasal	Close the lips for M, touch tongue on top for N	*time, name, home, come · ten, fine, phone, train*
7	**Initial S + consonant**	*"es-tudent", "es-pain", "es-tarbucks"*	Start directly with S — no "e" before	*student, Spain, Starbucks, school, stop, speak, small*

#	Problem	What Brazilians do	Fix	Drill
8	**Final L**	*"Brazil" → "Braziu", "hotel" → "hoteu"*	Tongue touches behind the top teeth at the end	*Brazil, hotel, call, feel, people, little*

Also: word stress (*HO-tel ✗ → ho-TEL*; *de-VE-lop*; *COM-for-ta-ble* = "COMF-ter-bul"); "I" sound in English is often "ai" (*idea = ai-DI-a*), and many silent letters (*walk, talk, half, Wednesday, listen, island*).

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2. False friends (falsos cognatos) — the dangerous ones

English word	Means	NOT	Portuguese meaning → English
actually	na verdade	atualmente	→ *currently / nowadays*
eventually	finalmente, com o tempo	eventualmente	→ *occasionally*
pretend	fingir	pretender	→ *intend / plan*
push	empurrar	puxar	→ *pull*
parents	pai e mãe	parentes	→ *relatives*
library	biblioteca	livraria	→ *bookstore*
lunch	almoço	lanche	→ *snack*
exquisite	requintado, refinado	esquisito	→ *weird / strange*
college	faculdade	colégio	→ *(high) school*
attend	frequentar, comparecer	atender	→ *answer (phone) / serve (customer)*
assist	ajudar	assistir	→ *watch*
realize	perceber	realizar	→ *achieve / accomplish*
sensible	sensato	sensível	→ *sensitive*
constipated	com intestino preso	constipado (resfriado)	→ *have a cold / congested*
injury	ferimento	injúria	→ *insult*
novel	romance (livro)	novela	→ *soap opera*

English word	Means	NOT	Portuguese meaning → English
fabric	tecido	fábrica	→ *factory*
legend	lenda / legenda de mapa	legenda (de filme)	→ *subtitles*
costume	fantasia	costume	→ *habit / custom*
prejudice	preconceito	prejuízo	→ *loss / damage*
support	apoiar	suportar	→ *stand / tolerate*
lecture	palestra	leitura	→ *reading*
resume (verb)	retomar	resumir	→ *summarize*
comprehensive	abrangente, completo	compreensivo	→ *understanding*
intend	ter intenção	entender	→ *understand*
exit	saída	êxito	→ *success*

3. "Translated" sentences — the grammar traps

❌ Brazilian translation	✅ Natural English	Note
I have 60 years.	**I'm 60.** / I'm 60 years old.	Age uses BE
I am agree.	**I agree.**	Agree is a verb
I'm with hunger / cold / headache.	**I'm hungry / cold. I have a headache.**	
Do you want that I help you?	**Do you want me to help you?**	
She said me…	**She told me…** / **She said (that)…**	tell + person
I lost the bus / the flight.	**I missed the bus / my flight.**	
I'm going to make a question.	**I'd like to ask a question.**	ask a question
I made a party / a trip.	**I had a party. I took a trip.**	
People is nice.	**People are nice.**	People = plural

❌ Brazilian translation	✅ Natural English	Note
I live here since 2010.	**I've lived here since 2010.**	Teach as chunk
It depends of…	**It depends on…**	
I'm thinking in going.	**I'm thinking about going.**	
Explain me…	**Explain to me… / Can you explain…?**	
I need go. / I want go.	**I need to go. / I want to go.**	
He don't like…	**He doesn't like…**	3rd person
Is very beautiful.	**It's very beautiful.**	English needs a subject
Have many people here.	**There are a lot of people here.**	"Tem" = there is/are
I stayed in the house.	**I stayed home / at home.**	
Do you like to have a coffee?	**Would you like a coffee?**	invitation
How do you call this?	**What do you call this?** / How do you say…?	
I'm boring.	**I'm bored.**	"boring" = chato (causes)
What means ___?	**What does ___ mean?**	question order
Where is the bathroom? (US)	**Where's the restroom?**	works, but restroom is more natural in public places
I want a beer.	**Could I get a beer, please?**	"I want" can sound rude

4. Conversation habits (cultural)

- **Too direct requests** ("Give me…", "I want…") → soften with *Could I…? / Can I get…? / I'd like…*. In English, politeness lives in the grammar.
- **Too long answers to officials** → in immigration and interviews, short and direct. Brazilians tend to explain too much when nervous.
- **Not saying "please", "thank you", "sorry", "excuse me"** often enough — English speakers use them constantly.
- **Interrupting / speaking at the same time** — normal in Brazil, can seem rude in the US/UK. Practice waiting for the end of the sentence.

- **Physical closeness / touching** — in many English-speaking countries, people keep more distance with strangers.
- **"Yes" when you didn't understand** — the most dangerous habit. Always: *"Sorry, could you repeat that?"*

Interview & Role-Play Question Bank

> Companion to **File 1 (3-Month Program)**. Use these in Session B/C role-plays. **How to use:** pick 8–10 questions per round. Mix the order. Add follow-ups (→). Change speed and "personality" (friendly / neutral-fast / serious).

Teacher rule: never give the student a memorized answer to repeat. Help them build **their own true answer**, short and clear. Real officers detect memorized speeches.

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1. Airport immigration / passport control

Opening:

- Good morning. Passport, please.
- Where are you coming from? / Where did you fly in from?
- Is this your first time in the United States / in Canada / in the UK?

Purpose & stay:

- What's the purpose of your visit? / Business or pleasure?
- How long are you planning to stay? → Why that long?
- When are you going back? → Do you have a return ticket? Can I see it?
- Where are you staying? → What's the address? → Who's paying for the hotel?
- What are you going to do here? → Which cities are you visiting?

People:

- Are you traveling alone? → Who's that with you?
- Do you know anyone here? → What does your son/daughter do here? → Is he/she a citizen?
- Are you visiting family?

Home ties (proof you'll go back):

- What do you do in Brazil? → How long have you worked there?
- Are you retired? → What did you do before?
- Do you own a house in Brazil? → Do you have family there?

Money & customs:

- How much money are you carrying? → Do you have a credit card?
- Are you bringing any food, plants or animals? → Any meat, cheese, fruit?
- Anything to declare? / Are you carrying more than $10,000?
- What's in this bag?

Closing (listening):

- *Look at the camera, please. / Put your right hand fingers here. Now your thumb.*
- *Enjoy your stay. / Welcome to the United States. / You're all set.*

Officer personalities for practice:

- **Friendly:** smiles, slow, short interview (2 min).
- **Neutral-fast:** no smile, very fast, 10 questions in 2 minutes.
- **Serious:** follow-up on every answer, asks for documents, silence pauses (students must not fill the silence with nervous talk).

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2. Visa interview (consulate) — practice version

> **Honest note for students:** at US consulates in Brazil, the interview is often available in Portuguese — confirm when scheduling. Practice in English anyway: it builds confidence and prepares for the airport, where the conversation *will* be in English. Always tell the truth; consistency with the application form (DS-160 for the US) is what matters.

- Why do you want to go to the United States?
- Have you ever been to the US before? → When? How long did you stay?
- Have you ever been refused a visa?
- Who's going with you?
- Who is paying for your trip?
- What do you do for a living? → How much do you earn per month?
- Are you married? → Does your spouse work? → Is he/she traveling with you?
- Do you have children? → Where do they live?
- Do you have relatives in the US? → What is their immigration status?
- What will you do after your trip?

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3. Hotel / accommodation

- Hi, welcome. Checking in? → Can I have your name? → Can I see your ID and a credit card?

- How many nights? / How many guests?
- Would you like to upgrade to a room with a view for $30 more?
- Breakfast is from 7 to 10 in the lobby restaurant. / Your room is on the 5th floor, the elevator is on your right.
- **Problem cards (student must call the front desk):** no hot water · neighbors are noisy · room not clean · AC broken · wrong room type (they booked a double, got a single) · charged twice on the card.

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4. Restaurant / café

- Hi! How many? / Do you have a reservation?
- Can I get you something to drink to start?
- Are you ready to order, or do you need a few more minutes?
- How would you like that cooked? / Which side would you like — fries, salad, or mashed potatoes?
- Any allergies I should know about?
- How is everything? / Can I get you anything else?
- Are you still working on that? / Do you want a box for that?
- Would you like to see the dessert menu?
- Together or separate checks?
- **Problem cards:** wrong dish · food is cold · there's a hair in the soup · the bill is wrong · you're vegetarian and there's meat in it.

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5. Getting around

- Where to? (taxi/Uber) → Which entrance? → Is here OK?
- (Station) Where are you heading? → One-way or round trip? → That'll be $12.50.
- (Car rental) Do you want full coverage insurance? / Will anyone else be driving? / Please return it with a full tank.
- (Stranger) You look lost — can I help you?
- **Problem cards:** the Uber didn't show up · wrong stop · the train is canceled · you got a parking ticket · flat tire.

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6. Doctor / pharmacy / emergency

- What seems to be the problem? / What brings you in today?
- When did it start? → Is it getting better or worse?
- On a scale from 1 to 10, how bad is the pain?

- Are you taking any medication? → Any allergies?
- Do you have travel insurance? → Can I see the card?
- (Pharmacy) Do you have a prescription? / Take one pill twice a day with food.
- (Police) What happened? → When and where? → Can you describe the person? → What was in the bag?
- (Lost luggage) Can I see your baggage claim tag? → Can you describe the bag? → Where can we deliver it?

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7. Small talk with strangers

- So, where are you from? → Oh, Brazil! I've always wanted to go. What's it like?
- Is this your first time here? → How do you like it so far?
- What do you do? / Are you here on vacation?
- How long are you in town for?
- Have you tried the ___ here yet? You have to!
- What's the best place to visit in Brazil? → Is it safe? → What's the food like?
- Do you speak Spanish? *(expect this one — many think Brazilians speak Spanish)*
- Are you a soccer fan?

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8. Telling stories & opinions (Phase 3)

- How was your trip? What was the best part? What was the worst part?
- Tell me about your hometown. How has it changed?
- What did you do for work? What did you like about it?
- What's the most beautiful place you've ever been to?
- If you could live anywhere, where would you live? Why?
- Do you prefer traveling with a group or on your own?
- What do you think about ___ (food in the US / big cities / technology)?
- What's something you've always wanted to do but never did?

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9. Bonus: job interview in English (for students who need it)

> Some students will want this. Add 2–4 sessions on top of the program if needed.

- Tell me about yourself. *(the 60-second "My Story" — they've been building it since Week 1!)*
- Why are you interested in this position?
- What are your strengths? / What's one weakness?
- Tell me about a time you solved a difficult problem. *(use the STAR method: Situation, Task, Action, Result)*
- Why did you leave your last job?
- Where do you see yourself in five years?
- Do you have any questions for us? *(they must always have 2!)*

Student Sheets (Fichas do Aluno)

> Companion to **File 1 (3-Month Program)**. Print or copy into Google Docs / WhatsApp.

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1. Diagnostic form

Aluno(a): _____ **Data:** //_____ **Idade:** ____

Parte A — Objetivos (em português)

1. Para onde você vai viajar? Quando? _____
2. Vai sozinho(a) ou acompanhado(a)? _____
3. Vai ter alguma entrevista? (visto / imigração / emprego) _____
4. Já estudou inglês? Onde e por quanto tempo? _____
5. O que mais te dá medo na hora de falar inglês? _____
6. Quanto tempo por dia você pode estudar em casa? _____
7. Usa bem WhatsApp áudio / YouTube / videochamada? ☐ Sim ☐ Mais ou menos ☐ Não

Parte B — Speaking sample (in English — record audio)

#	Question	Answered?	Notes
1	What's your name? Where are you from?	☐	
2	What do you do? / What did you do before you retired?	☐	
3	Tell me about your family.	☐	
4	What did you do last weekend?	☐	
5	Why do you want to travel to ___?	☐	
6	What would you do if you lost your passport?	☐	

Parte C — Listening (30-sec dialogue, 3 questions): ___ / 3

Parte D — Read aloud

> *"I think three hotels have the best rooms. I worked, I visited, I played. She wants to leave the ship at the beach."*

☐ TH ☐ H/R ☐ final -ED ☐ vowel length ☐ extra "i" ☐ S+consonant

Score (1–5)

Fluency __ · Comprehension __ · Vocabulary __ · Accuracy __ · Pronunciation __ · Interaction __ · **Total __/30**

Plan adjustments: _____

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2. "My Story" card (grows every week)

> The student builds this from Week 1 and reads it aloud often. By Week 12 it's a strong 2-minute self-introduction — useful for immigration small talk, new friends and job interviews.

Week	Add	My sentences
1	Name, age, city, why English	
2	Family, work / retirement, hobbies	
4	Why I'm traveling, where, how long	
6	Food I love, Brazilian food I'd recommend	
9	My city & Brazil — what I'd tell a foreigner	
10	One great memory / a story from my life	
11	My dream / my plans for the future	

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3. Weekly self-check

Week ___ · Theme: _____

This week I can…	😢	🙂	😄
_____	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐

The phrase I like most this week: _____ The phrase that is still hard: _____ Homework days completed: ☐ Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri

4. Personal Emergency Card (Week 8 — carry on the trip)

```
NAME: _____   NATIONALITY: Brazilian
DATE OF BIRTH: ___/___/____   BLOOD TYPE: ____
MEDICATIONS: _____
ALLERGIES: _____
MEDICAL CONDITIONS: _____
EMERGENCY CONTACT: _____  PHONE: +__ _____
HOTEL / ADDRESS: _____
TRAVEL INSURANCE: _____  PHONE: _____
BRAZILIAN CONSULATE (city): _____ PHONE: ____
EMERGENCY NUMBER in this country: _____ (US/Canada: 911 · UK: 999 · EU: 112)
"I speak a little English. Please speak slowly."
```

5. Final checklist & certificate

Before graduation, the student can:

- ☐ Introduce themselves for 2 minutes
- ☐ Ask for repetition / clarification without panic
- ☐ Check in at an airport and go through security
- ☐ Pass a 5-minute immigration interview (incl. "serious officer")
- ☐ Check in at a hotel and solve a problem
- ☐ Order at a restaurant, make a special request, pay & tip
- ☐ Buy tickets, take transport, ask for and follow directions
- ☐ Explain a health problem to a doctor / pharmacist
- ☐ Report a lost or stolen item
- ☐ Start, keep and end a small-talk conversation
- ☐ Tell a story about the past
- ☐ Give opinions and talk about plans

- [ ] Completed one real-world conversation in English

Score journey: Diagnostic __/30 → W4 __/30 → W8 __/30 → W12 __/30

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_____________________________________________________

          CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETION
         Speak to Travel — 12 Weeks
       Intensive English Conversation

  This certifies that _____________________
  completed 36 hours of conversation training
  and is ready to travel and speak in English.

  Teacher: Diogo Barbosa        Date: ________
_____________________________________________________
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